

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 767

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Ronald Wilson Durby of Hamilton County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Ronald Wilson Durby; and

WHEREAS, Ron Durby was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional known for his love of people, his fairness from the bench, and making people laugh; and

WHEREAS, born on October 31, 1942, Mr. Durby was raised in Memphis by his parents, Henry and Mary Zoe Durby; he earned his bachelor's degree from the University of Alabama, where he played guard on the 1964 Alabama Crimson Tide national championship team under Coach Paul "Bear" Bryant; and

WHEREAS, he continued his football career as a member of the coaching staff at the University of Tennessee at Chattanooga with Coach Harold Wilkes before moving to continue his education at the University of Tennessee, where he studied law; and

WHEREAS, Ron Durby returned to Chattanooga as a member of the Legal Aid Society before practicing law with Clarence Shattuck; in 1986, he became Clerk and Master in the Hamilton County court system, and he served the local community as a sessions court judge for eighteen years; and

WHEREAS, he was also actively involved in his community as a board member of the Valley Psychiatric Hospital, a member of the Red Bank Soddy Daisy Charitable Foundation, a member of the Bar Association, and a member of the Chattanooga Bass Club; and

WHEREAS, Ron Durby had a lifelong love of athletics and took pleasure in coaching those from Little League to the collegiate level in nearly every sport, from slow pitch softball to football; and

WHEREAS, he was a prominent face on the chain gang at Red Bank High School and an FCA representative; he was inducted into the Greater Chattanooga Hall of Fame for football in 2008; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Durby was a faithful member of Red Bank Baptist Church for fifty-one years, serving as a deacon, teacher, and committee leader; he was always the smiling face greeting others when they arrived at church; and

WHEREAS, he was also deeply devoted to his family and endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Durby is survived by his wife of sixty-two years, Vicka; his children, Machele (Tom) Hall and Mark (Jennifer) Durby; his grandchildren, Anna (Kevin) Barron, Abby, Arabella, and Isaac; his great-granddaughter, Ell; his sisters, Lynne Jamison and Carol (Kenneth) Miller; and numerous nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his in-laws, Ben and Ethelyn Hold; and his brother-in-law, Bob Jamison; and

WHEREAS, Ron Durby leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Ronald Wilson Durby, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Durby.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.